

THE END OF THE BEGINNING

WATERLOO

SQUARES

#15

Elle Lim: GBDA A4 Magazine Design



Introduction

Hi everyone, my name is Elle, and this is my reflection on my first term in the global business and digital art program and by extension university. My background in design stems from my high school program for traditional art and digital technologies such as the Adobe

Suite and the art fundamentals taught in this course such as the basic elements and fundamentals, so at the beginning of the program, I was sure I could handle the course especially because I already knew how to use the Adobe Suite kinda.



Truth be told, I don't think my perspective on design has changed much during this term, the biggest challenge for me was A3 because details and deeper meaning of art pieces have never been my strong suit, I've always held the technical and expressive aspects of art in higher regard than the introspective or symbolic, and my stance on it has not changed, I don't think I need to prescribe meaning to my art because since I am the one creating, I in turn will be reflected in my work if I put enough of myself into it. For this project, I started with the

photos, finding fun textures and art was a lot of work, but I found myself just looking through my camera roll of random things I just happened to take pictures of that weren't meant for the project, and those were my favourite images to include. Random selfies, moments, and cool stuff I found, were the real stars of the show.





What's changed?

Something that has really affected my design skills this term was trying to take a more cooperative approach to design. I found the group critiques at the end of projects very useful for identifying the flaws in my design vision, especially A2, which was created for a client. Taking their constructive criticism shed light on how I typically only listen to myself when creating, making myself tunnel visioned to the detriment of the product.



What about A4?

My favourite part of A4 aka this project was finding a way for the sets of pages to match each other, I think this particular page was interesting because I used my face to connect them, but more than that I used a bunch of random pictures I found to make a background I'm

proud of, along with the other pages I'm proud of the layout I made, it feels a little retro California sunset, playful but structured enough to feel like a proper magazine, easy to read but also fun to look at, like a comic book.

What I thought was interesting about the GBDA program is just how self-run it is the lectures are more of general information sessions while the real projects are up to interpretation, I felt this the most with A3, when making the video because it just is me by myself working compared to art classes at my high school where I could babble about my projects to the people around me.



Challenges

The hardest part in making the magazine was editing the photos I had taken to fit an aesthetic I liked because I had taken many of the photos when it was raining. The colours of the photos were too dull, so I turned up the image's saturation and used a lot of them as page textures, a lot of them are just graffiti scrawls on concrete that looked cool as overlays versus using flat backgrounds, most likely harder to work with, but so worth the risk



The other challenge with the magazine was that I had no idea how to begin, there were too many examples of magazines out there and none of them fit my internal style guide, so I started building with what I liked, graffiti, and bright colours, and something a little messy, and after the first collage mess, the rest of it poured out a little bit easier, and it was smooth sailing during most of the concept design phase.



FOR THE FUTURE

I'm hoping that the program gets more challenging in coming years because at the moment I feel stagnant, I want to do more and this term hasn't produced work I'm particularly giddy about. Some of my projects here feel a little lifeless like I'm just going through the motions of the creative process without having any of it

strike me spellbound, which is how I felt about some of my personal work or school work from previous years. But here's hoping for brighter skies in the years to come and for now I'll wait a little longer for something new.

